

NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd.

Code of Conduct

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1. Purpose

NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. is committed to maintaining the highest standards of professionalism, ethics, integrity, and accountability.

The Code of Conduct establishes the behavioral expectations for all employees, contractors, interns, consultants, and temporary staff while representing the company.

Every employee is responsible for understanding and complying with this policy.

Failure to comply may result in disciplinary action, including termination of employment where appropriate.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- Full-time employees
- Part-time employees
- Interns
- Temporary employees
- Contractors
- Consultants
- Third-party personnel working on behalf of NovaTech

The policy applies during:

- Office work
 - Remote work
 - Customer visits
 - Business travel
 - Company-sponsored events
 - Online meetings
 - Digital communications
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3. Our Core Values

Every employee is expected to uphold the following values.

Integrity

We act honestly, ethically, and transparently in every business decision.

Respect

We value diversity and treat every individual with dignity and professionalism.

Customer Focus

Customer success is central to every decision we make.

Collaboration

We believe teamwork produces better outcomes than individual effort alone.

Innovation

Employees are encouraged to improve products, services, and internal processes through continuous learning and creativity.

Accountability

Employees are responsible for the quality, accuracy, and timeliness of their work.

4. Professional Conduct

Employees are expected to conduct themselves professionally at all times.

Employees should:

- Be punctual.
- Meet deadlines.
- Communicate respectfully.
- Accept constructive feedback.
- Cooperate with colleagues.
- Maintain professional appearance during office visits and customer meetings.
- Follow company policies and applicable laws.

Employees must avoid:

- Offensive language.
- Threatening behavior.
- Workplace violence.
- Intimidation.
- Deliberate disruption of business operations.
- Falsification of company records.

Professional conduct is expected regardless of an employee's position or seniority.

5. Equal Employment Opportunity

NovaTech is committed to providing equal employment opportunities.

Employment decisions are based on:

- Qualifications
- Skills
- Experience
- Performance
- Business requirements

The company does not discriminate based on:

- Race
- Color
- Religion
- Gender
- Age
- Disability
- National origin
- Marital status
- Veteran status

Discrimination in any form is prohibited.

6. Anti-Harassment and Workplace Respect

NovaTech maintains a workplace free from harassment, bullying, intimidation, and retaliation.

Harassment may include:

- Offensive jokes
- Insults
- Threats
- Unwanted physical contact
- Inappropriate comments
- Offensive emails or messages
- Repeated intimidation

- Display of offensive material

Employees experiencing or witnessing harassment should immediately report the matter to:

- Their manager
- Human Resources
- The Ethics Committee

All complaints will be investigated promptly and confidentially.

Retaliation against individuals who report concerns in good faith is strictly prohibited.

7. Conflicts of Interest

Employees must always act in the best interests of NovaTech.

A conflict of interest exists when personal interests interfere with professional responsibilities.

Examples include:

- Working for a competitor without approval.
- Holding a financial interest in a competing organization.
- Hiring or supervising close family members without disclosure.
- Accepting personal benefits from vendors.
- Using company resources for personal commercial activities.

Employees must disclose potential conflicts immediately through the Conflict of Interest Declaration Form.

Human Resources and Legal will determine appropriate mitigation measures.

8. Confidentiality and Data Protection

Employees regularly access confidential information belonging to:

- Customers
- Employees
- Business partners
- Vendors
- NovaTech

Confidential information includes:

- Source code

- Product roadmaps
- Financial records
- Customer contracts
- Business strategies
- Security procedures
- Employee records

Employees must:

- Access only information required for their role.
- Store confidential data in approved systems.
- Encrypt sensitive files when required.
- Report suspected data breaches immediately.

Employees must never:

- Share confidential information externally without authorization.
- Email confidential files to personal accounts.
- Copy customer databases onto personal devices.
- Discuss confidential matters in public locations.

These obligations continue after employment ends.

9. Use of Company Assets

Company assets include:

- Laptops
- Mobile devices
- Software licenses
- Office equipment
- Cloud services
- Corporate credit cards
- Intellectual property

Employees should use company assets primarily for business purposes.

Limited personal use is acceptable provided it:

- Does not interfere with work.

- Does not violate company policies.
- Does not create additional cost.
- Does not compromise security.

Employees are responsible for protecting company property from theft, misuse, or damage.

10. Communication and Social Media

Employees represent NovaTech through their communication.

When communicating internally or externally, employees should:

- Be respectful.
- Maintain professionalism.
- Protect confidential information.
- Avoid misleading statements.
- Follow corporate branding guidelines.

Employees must not:

- Publish confidential company information on social media.
- Represent personal opinions as official company positions.
- Use offensive or discriminatory language while identifying themselves as NovaTech employees.

Only authorized spokespersons may communicate with the media on behalf of the company.

11. Gifts, Hospitality, and Bribery

Employees must avoid situations that could create the appearance of improper influence.

Employees may accept:

- Promotional items of nominal value.
- Business meals of reasonable value during legitimate meetings.

Employees must not accept:

- Cash or cash equivalents.
- Luxury gifts.
- Personal vacations.
- Expensive electronics.
- Gifts intended to influence business decisions.

Any gift with an estimated value exceeding **₹5,000** must be declared to Human Resources and the Compliance Team.

Bribery, kickbacks, and facilitation payments are strictly prohibited.

12. Reporting Misconduct

Employees are encouraged to report suspected violations of company policies.

Reports may be submitted through:

- Human Resources
- Reporting Manager
- Ethics Committee
- Anonymous Ethics Hotline
- Compliance Email

Good-faith reporting is protected under company policy.

Knowingly submitting false allegations may result in disciplinary action.

13. Disciplinary Actions

Violations of this Code of Conduct may result in one or more of the following actions depending on severity:

Violation Level	Possible Action
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Minor	Verbal counseling
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Repeated Minor	Written warning
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Moderate	Final written warning
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Serious	Suspension
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Gross Misconduct	Termination of employment
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Examples of gross misconduct include:

- Theft
- Fraud
- Data theft
- Workplace violence
- Bribery

- Deliberate disclosure of confidential information
- Falsification of financial records

Investigations will follow principles of fairness, confidentiality, and due process.

14. Employee Responsibilities

Every employee is responsible for:

- Reading this policy annually.
- Completing mandatory ethics training.
- Reporting policy violations.
- Protecting confidential information.
- Maintaining respectful workplace behavior.
- Cooperating during investigations.
- Complying with all applicable company policies.

Managers have additional responsibilities to:

- Lead by example.
 - Address concerns promptly.
 - Ensure team compliance.
 - Escalate policy violations when required.
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15. Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. Can I accept gifts from vendors?

You may accept promotional items or business meals of reasonable value. Gifts exceeding **₹5,000** must be declared to Human Resources and the Compliance Team.

Q2. Can I work for another company after office hours?

Outside employment that creates a conflict of interest or affects your performance requires prior written approval.

Q3. Can I post about my work on social media?

Yes, provided you do not disclose confidential information or represent personal opinions as official company statements.

Q4. What should I do if I witness harassment?

Report the incident immediately to your manager, Human Resources, or the Ethics Committee. Good-faith reporting is protected, and retaliation is prohibited.

Q5. Can I use my company laptop for personal work?

Limited personal use is allowed if it does not interfere with work, violate company policies, create additional costs, or compromise security.

Q6. What happens if someone deliberately leaks confidential information?

Deliberate disclosure of confidential information is considered gross misconduct and may result in termination of employment, subject to investigation.

Revision History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	January 2024	Initial Release
1.5	April 2025	Added Social Media Guidelines
2.0	January 2026	Updated Gift Declaration Threshold and Reporting Procedures